

years or longer. This may sound dull to you, but this person is crushing it and the large majority of Americans would weep tears of joy if they could be in such a strong financial position.

This is what wealth looks like; it is not flashy, and it takes time and commitment to build. Keep this in mind as you make your way through the pages of this book. As much as everyone would like to make boatloads of cash and live life like they do on their Instagram, Snapchat, or whatever-else-is-cool accounts, real wealth feels more like comfort than extravagance. If this still seems boring, consider the following statistics:

- 69% of Americans have less than \$1,000 in savings<sup>1</sup>
- 49% of Americans live paycheck to paycheck<sup>2</sup>
- 37% of Americans don't have enough cash to cover a \$400 emergency<sup>3</sup>
- 25% of adults skipped medical care, such as a visit to a doctor or dentist, in 2019 because they were unable to afford the cost, and 22% incurred a major unexpected medical expense during the year<sup>4</sup>

If you have experienced or witnessed the stress that comes from financial hardship, you probably already understand the value of

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1 Cameron Huddleston, "Survey: 69% of Americans Have Less Than \$1,000 in Savings," GOBankingRates, December 16, 2019, <https://www.gobankingrates.com/saving-money/savings-advice/americans-have-less-than-1000-in-savings>.

2 "Study: 53% of U.S. Adults Don't Have Emergency Fund," First National Bank of Omaha, February 19, 2020, <https://www.fnbo.com/insights/2020/newsroom/fnbo-releases-2020-financial-planning-survey>.

3 "Report on the Economic Well-Being of U.S. Households in 2019, Featuring Supplemental Data from April 2020," Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System, May 2020, <https://www.federalreserve.gov/publications/files/2019-report-economic-well-being-us-households-202005.pdf>.

4 Federal Reserve, "Report."